IB Ridge added to the thunderous sound of the Indian weapons within the confines of the pass. However, the Chinese numbers were overwhelming. Roy's men were being silenced one by one by the Chinese. Roy yelled to Sucha Singh to break contact and fall back with his section while Roy and the remaining soldiers would provide covering fire. As the Sikhs and some Assam Rifles men fell back in the dim pre-dawn light, Sucha Singh, at the rear of the column, turned back and looked at the flashes of exploding gunfire and stabbing bursts of small arms fire. The distinct sound of Indian weapons would continue sporadically as the men tried to hold out. Eventually, there was silence; the 5 Assam Rifles platoon had been wiped out and the position had been overrun.

At Bum-la, 1 Sikh's task was to make the pass, and hence the approach to Tawang, impassable. Delta Company held the first line of defence that extended from the IB Ridge to the Twin Peaks and onto Tongpeng-la. Hari Pal Kaushik, then twenty-eight years old, was a hockey player who had been a part of the team that won the gold medal at the Melbourne Olympics in 1956 (he would win another gold at the Tokyo Olympics two years later). Extremely cool under pressure, he had with him an outstanding artillery officer, Captain Gurcharan Singh Gosal, who was to act as a forward observer for the 7 (Bengal) Mountain Battery that would provide artillery cover from their 3.7-inch guns to the Sikhs. Gosal was not only extremely competent, he was also very diligent and methodical in his approach. On his own initiative, he had previously recorded all possible targets in and around Bum-la and set up a firing range, even though there were orders to the contrary. This had allowed Gosal to hone the accuracy of his gun crews who had made all the meteorological corrections that are so critical in high-altitude warfare.

Approximately three kilometres southwest of Bum-la, and west of the foot track, was the feature called Twin Peaks, from which one could observe most Chinese activity across the McMahon Line. Between the Twin Peaks and Bum-la on a stretch of flatland was the Inspection Bungalow. The nearby IB Ridge, roughly two kilometres south of Bum-la, was an ideal position to thwart access to Twin Peaks. No. 11 Platoon of Delta Company, under Subedar Joginder Singh, deployed at the IB ridge, had set up tactically sited bunkers and trenches on the forward slope of the ridge. The IB Ridge dominated the Bum-la bowl, and the climb from the bed of the